

# Sound Healing Certification

History



**LIFECHANGING**  
— ENERGY —

## **The History of Sound Healing**

Sound healing techniques have been practiced for thousands of years, from times when the lapping of ocean waves was considered a source of healing to the chantings of Tibetan monks.

This type of therapy has recently gained popularity in western medicine as a result of studies conducted on its therapeutic value and people looking for alternatives to modern medicine.

The first use of sound in healing dates back thousands of years. At that time, acupuncture was used to treat patients. The act of inserting needles into the body caused pain, which was then dulled by making sounds. The Chinese believed that the energy inside the human body was affected by the tone and vibrations created by these sounds. Through experience they discovered that certain sounds could heal various ailments in the body such as anger, fear or sadness.

Sound healing has also been used in Greece and other Mediterranean countries where it is sacred to Apollo and associated with sun worship. Ancient Greeks used music to heal physical wounds, sicknesses and mental problems. They believed that music could help them connect to their gods and access higher levels of consciousness. Sound healing has also been utilized throughout Europe during medieval times through musical chanting and religious ceremonies performed by monks and priests to cure mental illness and find spiritual enlightenment.

**Sound Healing has been practiced in all known cultures in one form or another.**

Sound Healing has been practiced in all known cultures in one form or another. The ancient healing traditions of the Aborigines, Tibetans, Indians, Egyptians and Greeks all used sound as a powerful medicinal therapy. Indigenous people all over the planet were aware of the relationship between sound and healing and how it can be used to access higher states of consciousness.

Ancient scriptures and early writings show that sound has been used to as early as 2000 b.c., where the ancient Egyptians used the power of sound to create healing temples. In all known cultures, sound therapy has been used in one form or another.

The most ancient roots of sound healing come from shamanic practices. The Shamans were the spiritual leaders who used music and chanting to bring about healing in their communities.

The Shamanic tradition is still alive today and continues to be practiced in various forms around the globe. Today's modern sound therapists also use drums, rattles and singing bowls, gongs, tuning forks, gongs, bells and voice to name a few.

There are two main categories of sound healing:

1. Active sound healing: This is when a person or group of people play musical instruments to create a "healing" environment. This can be done with one instrument or many instruments, and the combination of different types of instruments.
2. Passive sound healing: This is when a person or group of people listen to a recording or live music, or have their energy fields bathed in sound. Examples include listening to recorded music, attending live concerts, receiving a gong bath, etc.

**A number of ancient prehistory artifacts show evidence of sound being used as a healing tool.**

In his book, *The History of Sound Healing*, Jonathan Goldman writes: "In the Greek myths, Orpheus was able to charm the animals and even trees and stones with the power of his music. The ancient magicians... believed that the secret powers of ritual could be evoked with sound."

A number of ancient prehistory artifacts show evidence of sound being used as a healing tool. Thousands of years ago, our ancestors believed that illness was caused by evil spirits entering the body and upsetting its balance. They also believed that every illness had its own spirit, which could only be expelled by using the right sound. Many prehistoric objects have been found that look like trumpets or flutes; these are often thought to be healing instruments used by shamans.

Other cultures view sound as a way of stimulating certain areas of the brain, improving blood flow and circulation, relieving stress, and helping the body to heal itself.

Examples include the following:

The oldest known example of a flute is found in Slovenia and dates to about 43,000 years ago. It is carved from bone and has five finger holes, two tone holes and what may be a tuning hole on the bottom of its rounded end. The instrument has been dated to the so-called Gravettian culture, which lasted from about 28,000 to 22,000 years ago and is named after the site where their characteristic tools were first identified: La Gravette in southwestern France.

But it wasn't just the music that these ancient humans were after — many flutes were also decorated with geometric patterns and animal carvings. Ancient shamans believed that animal spirits could be called upon for healing and guidance through this artwork. This explains why some flutes are carved with images of bears, birds and wolves!

They've also found a 40,000-year-old Neanderthal flute made from a vulture bone.

In prehistoric Egypt, whistles made out of animal bones were used in healing ceremonies to drive away evil spirits.

The Australian Aborigines have a musical instrument called didgeridoo (di jer ee doo), which is believed to be one of the oldest instruments on earth. The instrument is played to invoke spiritual energy and is believed to help heal the physical body and mind.

The American Indians used rattles in healing rituals and believed that they helped to restore balance between mind and body.

Ornately decorated shaman drums were used by Native American Indians as tools for healing.

In Africa, drums are used for communication as well as in rituals and dances which are believed to bring good health to the community and its people.

There are other ancient prehistory artifacts show evidence of sound being used as a healing tool. This includes neolithic bone flutes, bullroarers, and rattles, as well as Egyptian trumpets and Tibetan bells. The Old Testament mentions playing

music as a powerful role in uniting people and bringing about peace, which was often an important part of the spiritual healing process.

Interestingly, in many prehistoric cultures, women were the predominant music healers. The earliest written records of healing with sound come from ancient Sumeria around 4500 B.C., where Temple Priests were said to chant incantations to rid their patients of disease. In ancient Egypt (approximately 3100-1085 BC), Imhotep (ee – mow- tep is credited with healing with sound and was later deified for his "magical" powers.

The oldest known lithophones (stone instruments) were found in France at an archeological site dated from the Middle Paleolithic period (c. 250,000 - 100,000 BC). Lithophones are musical instruments that produce sound by the vibration of flat stones struck together or rubbed against one another. These early musical instruments were probably not played for entertainment, but rather for magical or religious purposes. It is likely that they were used during gatherings aimed at promoting fertility or health and well-being.

Some artifacts have even been found with marks that suggest they were used to treat tooth pain. In some cultures, such as the ancient Egyptians and Chinese, animals were often depicted with their heads tilted back and mouths open to produce notes that might be used for healing.

More recently, in the 1900s, physicians began using ultrasound for imaging purposes, but it wasn't until the 1940s when microbiologist, inventor and researcher, Dr. Royal Rife, used audio frequency devices to study microbes that we began to uncover the true power of sound on the human body."

Dr. Rife exposed microorganisms to various electromagnetic frequencies in an attempt to destroy them. He was able to destroy cancer cells with electromagnetic frequencies. In 1934 he was able to cure 16 of 16 terminally ill cancer patients using these frequencies. Dr. Rife said his frequency generator could "annihilate virus and bacteria," and that it could "destroy any virus or bacteria within 15 minutes...that there was not a single disease on the face of the earth that could not be cured with his generator

Modern scientists have discovered that sound vibrations can be used to heal bones and treat wounds. The use of specialized tuning forks for healing purposes

has been documented as far back as ancient Greece, when they were used to locate blockages in the body's energy flow.

Modern researchers have found that sound can cause cells to vibrate in ways that could potentially promote healing. The results of studies using ultrasound waves on humans are mixed. However, many people with arthritis and other painful conditions say that listening to music helps them feel better.

### **The oldest written record of using sound for healing was recorded in ancient Egypt.**

One of the oldest written record of using sound for healing was recorded in ancient Egypt. The Ebers Papyrus document, which date back to about 1550 B.C., describes how priests would chant and play instruments to rid people of sickness and evil spirits – it was a form of spell to heal illness. They would also use sound as part of rituals to honor the gods.

In Greece, the father of medicine, Hippocrates, used music therapy to treat mental disorders and other illnesses around 400 B.C. He believed that music soothed the soul and helped people recover from their ailments.

Legendary Greek philosophers, including Plato, Aristotle and Pythagoras, believed that music could influence our moods and behaviors. In the fourth century B.C., Plato stated, "Rhythm and harmony find their way into the secret places of the soul."

Pythagoras said the universe was governed by mathematical relationships such as ratios and frequencies. He established a school that incorporated music into its teachings because he thought it played an important role in balancing the mind, body and spirit.

The Pythagoreans (500-300 BC) were the first to call attention to sound frequency and its relation to health and disease. They believed that each of the seven planets, which they identified as the moon, Mercury, Venus, the sun, Mars, Jupiter, and Saturn, produced a sound/vibration which affected life on earth. The sounds were musical but too low in frequency for humans to hear. Each planet was associated with a specific musical interval or tone. This relationship was called "The Harmony of the Spheres".

Aristotle considered music an essential part of education for cultivating virtue, character and emotional intelligence. He believed that listening to music had the power to heal sadness, fear and anger — all unhealthy emotions that can lead to illness if left unchecked.

We all know the saying, “Music soothes the savage beast!” There’s a lot of truth in that!

When we tune into the sound of a shaman's drum, or an overtone chant, we are tuning into the underlying structure of our own consciousness.

Western medical technology has only recently developed sophisticated equipment to measure the effect that sound has on us. And now science is discovering what ancient civilizations have known for thousands of years – that sound can profoundly affect our bodies and our minds.

**The Pythagoreans (500-300 BC) were the first to call attention to sound frequency and its relation to health and disease.**

The Pythagoreans (500-300 BC) were the first to call attention to sound frequency and its relation to health and disease. They noticed that certain sounds resonated well together (such as octaves), while others conflicted with one another. They also identified the health benefits of using these harmonious sounds to produce a healthy resonance in the body.

The ancient Greeks developed systems of music therapy called harmonics, musica universalis and musica humana, which are still practiced today. Hippocrates believed that all diseases were caused by a lack of harmony within the body, and he used music to help restore this balance.

Like Pythagoras, Plato believed that there was a definite connection between music and health/illness. Aristotle wrote about how music affected both emotion and physiology. He noted that fast rhythms accelerated the pulse whereas slow rhythms made it slower.

The Greek physician Galen (129-199 AD) believed that music had an appreciable impact on emotional states like anger, sadness or joy. He also believed it could soothe pain, induce sleep and even promote healing.

The Greek physician Galen's work with music therapy helped him discover that certain tones and rhythms could help emotions, pain and physical health. He believed that music therapy had a direct influence on the flow of fluids in the body, which he believed were responsible for emotional states.

According to Galen, music affected the four humors, or bodily fluids: blood, yellow bile, black bile, and phlegm. Each humor corresponded to a season, element, and body organ. Galen believed that if the humors were unbalanced by disease or injury, music could help realign them.

Galen's work on music therapy was widely accepted for centuries, until the Middle Ages when most scientific knowledge was disregarded in favor of religion – where they thought illness was caused by a special or divine cause.

In recent years scientists have found that music has an amazing ability to heal everything from depression to arthritis, hypertension and multiple sclerosis. The effects of music on the body are numerous and well-documented. Studies have shown that Mozart's Sonata for Two Pianos in D Major (K448) can reduce epileptic seizures and that Bach's Brandenburg Concerto No. 3 can reduce chronic pain, speed recovery from surgery and lower blood pressure.

A study done by Dr. Carol Richardson at Nottingham University in England showed how listening to classical music actually improves the harvest yield of plants when played over long periods of time.

Today it is widely recognized that sound plays a vital role in healing. We know that sound vibrations affect the body at a cellular level, which can have a profound effect on our health. For example, when we speak or sing, our vocal cords vibrate at a certain frequency and produce sound waves that travel through the air. Similarly, when an instrument is played, these sound waves are produced at certain frequencies and they begin to move outward until they encounter a solid object, such as our eardrums. Our ears then translate these frequencies into sounds we recognize as music.

We have seen advances in the field of quantum physics and the discovery of superstring theory, which reveals that all matter is essentially vibrating at different frequencies. It's now widely accepted that if an atom is disturbed it will produce a sound — or vibration.



Stress and trauma are held in the body and manifest as disease, dis-ease and discordant energy. Sound can literally transform our bodies on a cellular level by changing our vibration on a subatomic level. Sound healing is therefore able to shift us from feeling unwell to well.

**Plato and others outlined specific vibrational tonalities associated with each organ, gland and function in the body. Plato also had extensive discussions on musical theory in books such as Timaeus and the Laws.**

Everything in the universe has its own vibrational frequency and interacts with other frequencies. The belief that music can affect the body and mind goes back many years, and there are references to music therapy in ancient Indian, Chinese and Greek texts. Plato and others outlined specific vibrational tonalities associated with each organ, gland and function in the body. Plato also had extensive discussions on musical theory in books such as Timaeus and the Laws.

According to Plato, we are a musical instrument played by the gods. Music is a form of medicine because it affects our emotional health, which in turn affects our physical health. The ancient Greeks understood that music has an effect upon the soul (psyche) which is not only beneficial to the whole person but essential for a person's health and well-being. They believed music had healing properties and was used as therapy for mental disorders, depression and to aid digestion, relieve pain, induce sleep and promote recovery from diseases.

For instance, the heart was associated with a particular tone of yellow, while the lungs were associated with white. The liver was associated with bright red, kidneys with black, and so forth.

Modern research has confirmed that each organ resonates to a different energy frequency, and that by stimulating pulsating sound waves through a particular organ we can affect its resonance.

Plato also observed that music could influence people's moods in predictable ways – for instance, he noticed that fast-paced music tended to make people feel more excited and energetic, whereas slow-paced music tended to be calming and relaxing.

It's also been shown that playing classical music by composers such as Beethoven will calm quarrelling children and bring about a state of peace within a classroom

or nursery setting. Playing Mozart's music to babies can improve their spatial/temporal reasoning skills.

The modern term "music therapy" originated in the 19th century but its roots can be traced back thousands of years to primitive cultures. In 1789, Swiss physician and musician Franz Joseph Gall (1758-1828) developed a theory that suggested that certain organs were controlled by specific parts of the brain (Phrenology). He believed that stimulating these areas with music could improve a person's health.

In 1841, Belgian violinist and conductor Jean Jacques Perreyon (1796-1880) published a book titled "Du Système nerveux et de son influence sur les mouvements du corps humain" in which he proposed that music could be used for therapeutic purposes.

In 1897, British surgeon Sir William Withey Gull (1816-1890) published an article describing a 12 year old patient who had lost her speech after suffering from "ulceration of the throat." The girl's case was remarkable because she had been unable to speak for three years, yet her other senses and mental faculties remained unaffected. After a time, it was discovered that the girl's problem lay with the nerves that controlled her vocal cords.

What makes this case noteworthy, however, is not the disorder itself but rather its cause. Gull believed that the girl's condition was psychosomatic — caused by her mind rather than by an organic illness due to bacteria or virus. The girl's mother reported that during their trip to London she had become more and more anxious about meeting new people and making new friends. At first Gull thought that the girl might be faking her symptoms. But once he became convinced that she was not malingering, he attributed her loss of speech to "some mental shock which she could not describe or explain."

Gull's theory attracted little attention at the time because it seemed too speculative. In fact, it took nearly 50 years before anyone else proposed a similar explanation for any illness.

Sometimes it's difficult for people to even conceive of other ways of thinking about health and disease, but most medical traditions are based on holistic approaches that emphasise the importance of harmony between mind, body

The interactions between sound and the human body are currently being researched by doctors, musicians, psychologists and mathematicians from many countries around the world. As a result of this research, we now know that sound can produce positive effects on our physical, emotional, mental and spiritual health by changing brainwave patterns through EN-TRAIN-MENT (the tendency of two sound waves of similar frequencies to synchronize).

If we expand these concepts to consider the human voice as an instrument capable of producing a variety of sounds with different tonalities or vibrations, it is not hard to imagine that we could also use our own voices as a therapeutic tool.

## **China**

In ancient China, the famous Taoist sage Lao Tzu wrote about the healing powers of music in his classic text, Tao Te Ching. He recommended that people purify their spirits with music several times a day to stay in optimal health.

Today we know what he meant.

When you listen to the right kind of music, it can lower your blood pressure and heart rate, put you in a more relaxed state, help you breathe more deeply and think more clearly, create an overall sense of well-being, and even help your body heal itself.

"Music is the melody of life," said Dr. Oliver Sacks, a renowned British neurologist who wrote several books on the effects of music on mood and brain function.

"We are literally attuned to it."

"An external rhythm or tempo can entrain our internal rhythms to synchronize with it," explains Anita Collins, an expert on neuroscience and music education.

"Our heart rate, breathing and brain waves all begin to move into sync with the pulse or tone we're hearing."

The feeling of relaxation that many people experience when listening to soothing music is due, in part, to a natural process known as entrainment. Entrainment helps us sync with an external rhythm or frequency through our nervous systems and brains.

Modern research is beginning to bear out what these ancient sages knew long ago-that music truly does heal. Maybe you've experienced how uplifting a favorite tune can be or how some songs can bring tears to your eyes. Music can strike a chord deep within us, where no other activity can reach.

### Healing Music Reduces Pain

Music has been shown to reduce pain by activating the endorphin pathways and blocking pain signals from being transmitted to the brain. A study published in a 2007 issue of The Journal of Advanced Nursing found that listening to music reduced pain by 21 percent compared to patients who were given only "usual care." In addition, there was no need for pain medication or a reduction in medication when patients listened to music.

### Healing Music Lowers Anxiety

Music also plays an important role in today's modern health care system. It's used to calm patients and prepare them for surgery, and as an aid to help patients relax and manage pain during labor, childbirth and recovery. Some hospitals even have dedicated music therapists on staff to use music to help patients heal.

### Healing Music Lowers Stress

Another important way that music can improve health is by lowering stress. In a study conducted at Stanford University School of Medicine, patients who were recovering from surgery were put in two groups: one group listened to classical music for 30 minutes before surgery, during surgery, and for 30 minutes afterward; the other group was not exposed to any music. The study found that the group exposed to music had significantly lower levels of stress hormones during surgery than those in the control group.

Studies show that music has a beneficial effect on the immune system in general, and it can help to boost the production of what are called "natural killer cells" which are vital to fighting off infections, viruses, and cancer. Music can also help lower blood pressure, reduce stress levels, and elevate mood.

Music's healing powers are most effective at the deepest levels of the mind. The emotional component of music can elicit powerful responses in our bodies, changing our heart rate, hormone levels, and even how we breathe. Listening to

complex music helps to increase brain function and memory processing. Music therapy has also been shown to improve mental health by decreasing stress and depression while increasing self-esteem.

**The first book on Chinese medicine, Huang Di Nei Jing, stated that over 90% of the illnesses at that time could be treated with sound healings if applied correctly.**

In the late 19th century it was discovered that certain frequencies could produce specific effects in the body. These frequencies were later used to treat disease and illness.

The Father of Modern Sound Healing, Dr. Alfred A. Tomatis, studied the effect of sound on the human body for around 50 years. His research revealed that many physical and mental problems can be attributed to problems with a person's hearing. He found that most people only hear at about 20% of their capacity; this means that 80% of what we hear is not being heard at all!

Tomatis concluded that because we hear so little, our bodies and minds become unbalanced; this is when they begin to malfunction and we get sick.

Tomatis also found that by listening to certain types of music, we can actually retrain our ears so they are able to hear more clearly once again.

The first book on Chinese medicine, Huang Di Nei Jing, stated that over 90% of the illnesses at that time could be treated with sound healings if applied correctly.

"Sound" in this context means the frequencies of music (or just about any sound) and the way you use it for healing.

A good example of how to use sound for healing is listening to music. Music has a healing effect on your body whether you realize it or not. With each note you hear, your body receives a set of frequencies that are either harmonious or dissonant to your body's natural cellular frequency. This is called resonance.

The first book on Chinese medicine, Huang Di Nei Jing, stated that over 90% of the illnesses at that time could be treated with sound healings if applied correctly.

The ancient Egyptians believed in the power of music and used it extensively for healing purposes. They associated the seven musical tones with the seven planets in the solar system, and the seven chakras or energy centers of the human body.

The seven main chakras are:

1. Root Chakra (Muladhara)
2. Sacral Chakra (Svadhithana)
3. Solar Plexus Chakra (Manipura)
4. Heart Chakra (Anahata)
5. Throat Chakra (Vishuddha)
6. Third Eye Chakra (Ajna)
7. Crown Chakra (Sahasrara).

Sound therapy is similar to music therapy in that it uses sound vibration to restore balance and health. However, a music therapist may use instruments or singing to help a client process emotions or communicate while a sound healer will use pure sounds such as singing bowls, tuning forks, tuning tubes, and gongs.

Sound healing is the therapeutic application of sound frequencies to the body/mind of a person with the intention of bringing them into a state of harmony and health. It is based on the idea that all matter (including the human body) is vibrating at specific frequencies. Disease, illness and pain are thought to be caused by blockages or imbalances in these natural vibratory rates. When these blockages are removed, health and well-being is restored.

Sound healing can be accomplished using a variety of instruments such as Tuning Forks, Gongs, Singing Bowls and many more. One instrument which has been used for thousands of years for sound healing is our voice.

The use of sound to create healing and transformation has been part of many ancient traditions from around the world.

Recent studies have shown that the human brain responded to sound vibrations in a way that helped heal many ailments such as:

back aches

headaches

sciatica

neck and shoulder pain

carpal tunnel syndrome

arthritis pain

muscle spasms and strains

fibromyalgia

sinus problems

## **Greeks and Romans**

Greeks and Romans used sound healing tools as well. They used singing bowls, gongs and bells to treat physical ailments, mental illness and pain relief. In the 17th century, Jesuit monks built an entire system of medicine based on the principle of vibrational medicine.

In Ancient Greece and Rome, the great philosophers Pythagoras, Aristotle and Plato all saw the healing potential of music. They used was called "musical medicine" to treat mental disorders and calm unruly prisoners.

## **Singing Bowls**

Some of the first evidence of singing bowls date from between 500-1000 B.C in Asia. The Tibetan Singing Bowl is believed to date back to as early as 2500 B.C.

The ancient Greeks and Romans employed singing bowls in their ceremonies and rituals, while they also used them as musical instruments and tools for healing

various ailments because of their ability to produce vibrational energy that could affect an individual on all levels – physical, emotional and spiritual.

In the modern world of vibration healing, crystal bowls are a common tool. The use of crystal bowls for healing dates back to the ancient Egyptians and Tibetans. Crystal bowls are made from quartz and other minerals that vibrate at different frequencies.

Crystal bowls are often used alongside other sound healing tools like tuning forks or gongs in a process called sound bathing. Sound baths may also involve chanting or drumming. The idea is that vibrations from these sounds can help someone reach a meditative state or even achieve an altered state of consciousness.

In the 1970s, researchers found that sound healers could induce specific brainwave states by playing certain tones on a singing bowl. Scientists have also discovered that certain brain states can be induced by playing specific tones on a singing bowl.

Humans have been using sound vibrations for thousands of years as a form of health care. In the 1800s, physician Edward Bach began to study the connection between illness and negative emotions. He created his own system of healing that is still in use today – Bach Flower Remedies (or BFR). The goal of BFR is to help patients feel calmer, more relaxed and more emotionally balanced.

In the early 1900s, Dr. Hans Jenny studied cymatics which we will go into more detail later — it's the study of visible sound frequencies. He used various frequencies through a loud speaker, which used sand on top of the speaker cone to show how different frequencies changed the shape of the sand particles into geometric patterns. The human body is made up of millions of cells that vibrate at certain frequencies, so it's not surprising that music created with certain frequencies can bring about positive health benefits.

Devices like the vibroacoustic chair and treatment table were more recently developed to induce relaxation using sound.

## **Early Indian (Hindu) Healing Traditions**

The ancient system of health care was developed by the sages of India and was not only concerned with medicine, but also with philosophy and spirituality. The



Sanskrit word ayurveda is made up of two words: ayus means life and veda means knowledge. These two words together signify "the science of life."

In early Indian (Hindu) healing traditions, the body is viewed as a microcosm of the universe. The Vedas, a set of sacred Hindu scriptures written around 1500 BCE, contains the first references to sound and music therapy. Sound was considered an essential part of breathing and meditation practices, and was thought to calm the mind and awaken consciousness, according to the book *Musicology: A History of Musical Tones in Healing*.

Sound therapy was also used in yoga practice. The yogis believed that sound had healing powers when practiced as part of Pranayama (yogic breathing), according to Vedic scholar David Frawley. In his book *Yoga and Ayurveda: Self-Healing and Self-Realization*, he wrote that mantra chanting "has positive effects on our physical health by affecting our respiration, blood circulation, nervous system and endocrine glands."

The Vedic concept of Nada Brahma (the world is sound) emphasizes how deeply interconnected all aspects of life are. According to Dr. Alan Watkins' audio course "Sound & Consciousness," chanting "is not about singing or praying; it's about changing your state of consciousness."

The Shiksha Veda, from the Vedic period, describes a system of phonetics and pronunciation. In early Indian (Hindu) philosophy, sound was considered one of the five elements (Earth, Air, Fire, Water and Ether or Space). These elements are related to different aspects of the body.

The Shiksha Veda describes how to pronounce the Vedas correctly in order to evoke a healing response in the body. Sound is used to activate and harmonise these energies, which are also reflected as chakras in the body.

The ancient Vedic system of healing with sound was developed over thousands of years and is known as Nada Yoga. Other systems of healing with sound from this period include Mantra Yoga (which is still practiced today), Japa Yoga and Tantric Yoga.

Sound is energy and can affect our bodies at the cellular level – please remember that it can be used to heal or harm.

## **Native Americans believed in the spiritual power of sound**

There are many ancient healing traditions that use sound, such as the Australian Aborigines and Native Americans. In modern times, we've seen great research on sound healing by Dr. Mitchell Gaynor, a medical doctor who founded the Center for Integrative Medicine at Cornell University Medical Center in New York City. Drs. Tomatis and Densmoore also did pioneering work with sound and hearing improvement.

"For thousands of years, the indigenous people of North America believed that sound vibrations could be used to heal and bring people into balance," writes sound therapist Anneapurna. "The first doctors were called 'the keepers of the voice,' and they devoted themselves to singing sacred songs to heal others."

Native Americans believed in the spiritual power of sound to heal the body, mind, and spirit. The Hopi tribe's creation myth is based on this principle: "In the beginning there was no land, only sea. But all creatures lived below in the Third World. When they decided to come up to this world they sent a Rainbow to explore it. The Rainbow came back saying that there was nothing here. So they sent Insects and when they returned they told the same thing. Finally the Hummingbird was sent up and it came back with mud in its little beak which it dropped on Turtle's back, creating land."

This myth teaches that sound vibration contributed to the very creation of life on earth; if it could create something as big as a world, then surely it could also be used for healing purposes.

The Native Americans believed in the spiritual power of sound to heal the body and the soul. The American Indians were taught that a person's spirit was divided into three parts: one part resided in the physical body, another in the heart, and a third in the mind. Each part had a different function and could be healed by a corresponding sound.

When a person fell ill, tribal members would gather and chant or sing to create certain sounds that would heal all three parts of their souls. In this way, music served as an object of worship that helped people connect with their spirit guides and communicate with nature.

Many Native Americans believe in the spiritual power of sound to heal the body, mind, and spirit. Singing, drumming and dancing are considered sacred ceremonies by some tribes, while other tribes see them as social activities. The drumbeat is often used to induce a trance state that is believed to allow individuals to communicate with the spirit world.

The ceremonial use of song and dance also helps communities come together to celebrate special occasions, such as weddings, funerals and births. Some ceremonies are performed by medicine men or shamans who are believed to have more spiritual power than other community members.

Singing is frequently accompanied by dancing. Each tribe has its own style of dance that has evolved over generations. Sometimes the dances are performed with a specific purpose in mind, such as wishing for a good crop. Other dances are simply for entertainment.

The Drum is the heartbeat of Mother Earth. It is a powerful force that unites all of creation, both physical and spiritual, into one rhythm.

The drum has been used for thousands of years to heal the body, mind, and spirit. The Native American Indians believed in the spiritual power of sound and they used it in ceremony to bring healing to those who were ill.

The Native Americans believe that when a person's heart is not right with the Great Spirit, that person will become ill. If they could find out what was wrong with their heart, they would be able to correct it and make them well again. To do this they would use ceremony to communicate with the spirits so they could get answers from them about what was wrong with their heart.

The Native Americans also believed that if someone did something wrong to them or hurt them in any way, it would affect their spirit and cause trouble for them later on down the road. They believed that if you did something bad to someone else it would come back on you like a boomerang effect.

From the wind blowing through the trees to the ocean's waves crashing ashore, Native Americans experienced the world with all their senses. They believed that everything in nature had a spirit and that music, dance and sound could be used to heal the body.

When they gathered for spiritual ceremonies, they used music as a way of communicating with the creator. They used drums and rattles to represent drumming of the heart and believed that this had healing power. They also sang songs from their own tribes or other tribes to try to bring peace.

Native Americans used song to call their ancestors back to them and to make children feel welcome. When a child was born, songs were sung on the third day after birth to welcome him or her into the world. Songs were also sung when someone was dying, as a way of helping them leave this world peacefully and without fear.

The sound of the drum, in particular, is said to heal because it creates a state of deep relaxation that allows one to enter the healing state.

The Native American flute has also been used for centuries for healing purposes. For example, some people believe that the flute can help to relieve stress and anxiety, as well as boost mood and energy.

The construction of Native American flutes have varied greatly among indigenous peoples, with some being made of wood, horn, bone, or cane; however, almost all share several common elements. These include a hollow body with finger holes along one side; a blow hole near one end through which air is directed into a duct within; and voice holes that are placed at or near one end of the duct and provide an exit for air from inside it. Voice holes are typically located either above or below one or more of the finger holes (or both). Some type of block is usually used to close off air.

### **Hildegard von Bingen (1098-1179 AD)**

As you've been learning, sound healing has been used in many cultures since antiquity. The ancient Greeks, Egyptians and Romans used music in healing rituals, as did the Native American tribes.

Hildegard von Bingen (1098-1179 AD) was a Benedictine mystic and composer who was one of the first female composers in history. She recorded her musical compositions during medieval times with specific intention to heal listeners. Her music, which has been played in churches around the world since her death, has also been used by sound therapists and practitioners of healing arts. In fact, it is said that she was one of the first people to use music as a healing modality. As a

note, she also wrote extensively about plants, animals and natural phenomena, as well as theological matters. Her work on natural history is considered an early form of modern science.

She wrote, "All sounds that come from the mouth of man express some mental condition, because they are formed by a movement of the spirit which stirs within the body of man, so that they may be heard outside. Thus there is great power in sounds..."

In the 11th century, Hildegard composed the earliest known musical compositions by a woman and she also is credited with creating a system of musical notation. She introduced the use of different colors to indicate moods, temperaments, and tones. Her work became very influential in her time and still is today. It has influenced music therapy as well as modern day sound healing techniques. She was also a writer, poet, philosopher, herbalist, visionary, and Christian mystic. She wrote extensively on topics ranging from botany to theology. To this day her writings are used as reference material for many natural healing remedies.

As a visionary mystic, Hildegard saw herself as an instrument of God's love and she experienced visions throughout her life beginning at age 5 until her death at 81 years old. Some people viewed them as mystical experiences while others claimed that they were hallucinations or the result of epilepsy. Regardless of the cause, her visions led to some amazing accomplishments which have made lasting impressions on our society even to this day.

Hildegard also believed that singing is a wonderful stress reliever, which is why she taught her nuns how to sing along with her music and her music is still played to this day by many monks and nuns around the world.

## **Modern Science of Sound Healing**

Sound is a form of mechanical energy. It travels in waves through mediums such as air, water and solids, whereas light is electromagnetic energy that travels in waves through space; sound cannot travel through space because there is no medium. The energy of sound can be captured and converted into other forms of energy or electricity.

The Academy of Sound Healing is based in the United Kingdom and is one of the first and most prominent research institutions for sound healing.

They have found that sounds can be used for:

Treating depression, stress, and anxiety

Improving immune system functioning

Benefitting cancer patients

Stimulating circulation

Reducing inflammation

Increasing bone density in osteoporosis patients

Healing wounds faster.

Scientists are now discovering that sound healing has many applications. Like mentioned before, it can be used to treat stress, pain, and even certain diseases because Sound healing can be used to repair and harmonize the body.

Sound is composed of waves that travel through the air at different frequencies. Each frequency corresponds to a musical note or pitch. Musical notes can be arranged in different octaves or scales, just like notes on a piano keyboard.

Healing sounds produce different frequencies that affect our physical and energetic bodies in different ways. The human ear can hear sounds from about 20 Hz up to 20,000 Hz (20 kHz). But we can also feel more subtle vibrations in other parts of the body, down to 0.1 Hz, which is below the lowest note on a grand piano.

Sound healing is a form of vibrational medicine that uses the power of sound to repair imbalances in the body, mind, and spirit.

Sound healing works by applying the harmonic frequencies that resonate with different parts of our body to bring them back into balance.

As humans, we've come to understand that we are much more than flesh and bone; we are energy beings. We are made up of different energetic systems — such as the chakra system mentioned before too — which connect us to the

physical world around us. Sound can help us access these hidden realms, tapping into our subconscious and opening up a realm of possibilities.

The ancient Egyptians used sacred chants and sounds in their rituals to reach altered states of consciousness, or ASCs, which allowed them to make sense of their dreams and visions. Sound can be used for spiritual guidance and healing, personal development, and guidance about your future path.

The rhythmic and melodic components of music are thought to have a direct effect on the brain — specifically, the temporal lobe. This is where our perception of time, memory and language are processed. It's also one of the main areas associated with emotions. This is why we experience such powerful reactions to music and sound.

Today, more and more people are discovering the power that sound has on our moods. Many celebrities, including Oprah and Madonna, swear by it.

Sounds can make us sad or happy; they can cause anxiety or relaxation. And this is why many people are now using sound as a means of healing.

Today there are many sound healers who are using a variety of techniques both ancient and modern to help people heal themselves at all levels: body, mind, emotion and spirit.

The modern era of sound therapy and sound healing began in 1960s when Dr Alfred Tomatis developed his technique called 'The Listening Program'.

He found that listening to recorded music can help improve hearing loss and balance issues that occur due to ageing.

Sound is now recognized as a legitimate healing modality.